

Cyber Cafe Deployment Guide

Local setup, environment variables, and live hosting checklist

1. Local Setup

- Create and activate a virtual environment
- Install dependencies from requirements.txt
- Configure .env values for Google and payment settings
- Run python app.py locally

2. Production Checklist

- Set SECRET_KEY to a strong random value
- Set FLASK_DEBUG=0
- Deploy with gunicorn app:app
- Configure the exact Google redirect URIs for local and live domains
- Regenerate OAuth client secret if it has been exposed during testing

3. Required Environment Variables

Variable	Example
SECRET_KEY	change-this-in-production
GOOGLE_CLIENT_ID	<google client id>
GOOGLE_CLIENT_SECRET	<google client secret>
GOOGLE_ADMIN_EMAIL	admin@example.com
PAYMENT_UPI_ID	name@bank
PAYMENT_RECEIVER	Cyber Cafe

4. Hosting Notes

GitHub stores the code but does not host the Flask runtime. Use a Python-capable host such as Render, Railway, or PythonAnywhere. Store secrets in host-managed environment variables rather than committing them into a repository.

For production, move uploaded screenshots and business data to persistent storage so restarts do not erase state.

5. Recommended Next Upgrade

The strongest next improvement is introducing SQLite or PostgreSQL for users, payments, sessions, and logs. That single change would make the project much more credible for deployment and academic submission.

